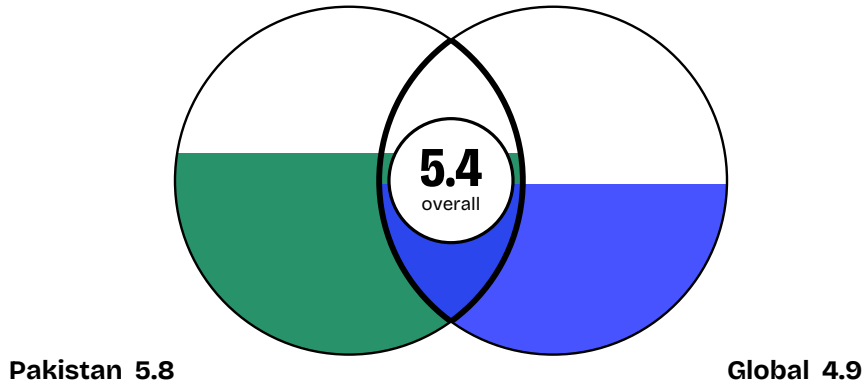
Evaluation sheet

CropLink

Prepared for Ayesha Raza | Stage: Have notes & started researching | 24 October 2026



Needs validation: Validate further before building

Demand looks real, but logistics, unit economics and farmer trust are unproven. A small manual pilot will answer these cheaply before any build.

The idea

A WhatsApp-based marketplace that lets small Punjab farmers sell directly to urban grocers, cutting out commission agents.

Pakistan 5.8/10 Needs validation

The problem is real and a focused pilot near Lahore and Multan is realistic. Logistics, trust and thin margins, not demand, decide whether it works.

Global 4.9/10 High risk

The problem exists in many markets, but a WhatsApp-first marketplace has little defensibility alone. Global potential depends on a repeatable, profitable playbook proven in Pakistan first.

Biggest strength

A clearly felt problem with first-hand evidence and a narrow, testable starting market.

Biggest risk

Delivery, spoilage and trust costs could erase a thin margin before the model proves itself.

Priority actions

1. Run a four-week manual pilot with 10 farmers and 5 grocers in one district and measure net price gain, spoilage and delivery cost per kilo.
2. Sign a logistics or cold-chain partner and price the delivery leg per order before writing any software.
3. Use no-code WhatsApp tools or find a technical co-founder so the ordering flow can ship in weeks.
4. Interview 15 arthis and 15 farmers to learn what credit and guaranteed buying they offer and how to match it.

Pakistan market: 5.8/10, Needs validation

#	Criterion	Score	Why
1	**Market Demand & Problem Severity**	8/10	Farmers losing a large share of crop value to commission agents is a recurring, well-known pain. The founder has seen real sale slips, and grocers also feel price and freshness problems.
2	**Total Addressable Market & Reachable Demand**	7/10	Punjab has a huge smallholder base and a large urban grocery market. Only connected farmers near Lahore and Multan are reachable at first, which still gives a workable pilot.
3	**Purchasing Power & Willingness to Pay**	5/10	Farmers switch only if net income beats the arthi after fees and payment delays. Grocers may move for a 10% saving but are used to wholesaler credit.
4	**Revenue Model & Local Unit Economics**	5/10	A small take-rate on thin-margin produce can be wiped out by delivery and spoilage costs. Unit economics are untested and no logistics partner is signed.
5	**Competition & Existing Alternatives**	6/10	The mandi and arthi system is entrenched and offers credit and guaranteed buying. Named rivals exist, but a WhatsApp-only, two-district focus is a credible wedge.
6	**Digital & Physical Infrastructure Readiness**	6/10	WhatsApp and mobile wallets are widely used, but cold-chain, reliable delivery and rural connectivity are uneven, and no payment or logistics stack is planned yet.
7	**Regulatory, Legal & Tax Feasibility**	7/10	A produce marketplace faces few licences, but market-committee rules, food safety and sales-tax registration need checking. Arthis may resist being bypassed.
8	**Supply Chain & Operational Feasibility**	4/10	Perishables need aggregation, grading, transport and returns handling. A solo non-technical founder with no logistics partner is the weakest link in the plan.
9	**Trust, Adoption & Customer Behavior**	5/10	Farmers' arthi relationships include credit and trust, so a young newcomer must prove on-time payment. Village agents can help, but trust builds slowly.
10	**Scalability, Resilience & Local Execution**	5/10	Repeating district by district is feasible, but inflation, fuel costs and crop seasonality strain thin margins, and local execution capacity is the limit.

Global market: 4.9/10, High risk

#	Criterion	Score	Why
1	**Global Market Size & Growth Potential**	6/10	Digital agri supply chains and B2B produce marketplaces are a large, growing category worldwide, but a single-country WhatsApp model addresses only a slice of it.
2	**Global Problem-Solution Fit**	6/10	Intermediary losses for smallholders appear in many emerging markets, so the problem travels. Logistics and credit needs differ a lot by country.
3	**Competitive Advantage & Defensibility**	4/10	A WhatsApp-first, hyper-local approach is easy to copy, and funded agri-tech firms already operate in several emerging markets. There is no data or network moat yet.
4	**Global Business Model & Profitability**	5/10	Take-rate marketplaces can work at scale, but logistics-heavy models often struggle with profit abroad. Produce is close to a commodity, which limits pricing power.
5	**Scalability & Replicability**	5/10	The playbook of aggregating, grading and delivering can be repeated, but each country needs local agents and logistics, so scaling is operations-heavy.
6	**International Regulatory & Legal Compatibility**	6/10	Food safety, trade and data rules vary by country, but few block a marketplace outright. Payments and licensing need country-level checks.
7	**Localization & Cross-Cultural Fit**	5/10	Language, crops, payment habits and WhatsApp reliance differ by region, so each new market needs local partnerships and product changes.
8	**Customer Acquisition & Distribution Potential**	4/10	Reaching farmers abroad depends on field agents or cooperatives, which are costly and slow to build. No channel plan beyond Pakistan exists yet.
9	**Capital Requirements & Funding Attractiveness**	4/10	Logistics-heavy marketplaces need real working capital, and investors want proven unit economics that a pilot-stage solo founder cannot yet show.
10	**Market Entry Risk & Long-Term Resilience**	4/10	New countries add currency, regulatory and supplier risk. Resilience depends on proving the model in Pakistan before any expansion.

How to read this sheet. An AI agent scored each criterion from 1 to 10 using the FoundersLens evaluation framework (ten criteria for Pakistan, ten for the global market). A market score is the average of its ten criteria and the overall score is the average of the two market scores. Bands: 8 and above Strong, 6.5 to 7.9 Promising, 5 to 6.4 Needs validation, 3.5 to 4.9 High risk, below 3.5 Weak. Scores are directional judgements, not verified market data.